CLASS 10 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 13–17: **Power-sharing (Political Science), Federalism (Political Science), Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science), Political Parties (Political Science), Outcomes of Democracy (Political Science)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. In which situation is power sharing not being practised? 1

(a) Different organs act as checks
(b) Provincial governments have fixed powers
(c) One leader controls all organs of government
(d) Parties form a coalition

2. A reservation of at least one-third for women in local bodies tells us that the system of local government: 1

(a) applies only to the Centre
(b) applies only in cities
(c) has abolished other reservations
(d) is designed to increase women's representation

3. Which of the following is correct about the relation between caste and politics? 1

(a) Castes never form coalitions
(b) Caste plays no role in nominations
(c) Politics also changes caste identities as caste groups enlarge and form coalitions
(d) Politics has ended caste groups

4. Match: 1 Congress; 2 BJP; 3 CPI-M; 4 Telugu Desam with A NDA; B State party; C UPA; D Left Front. Correct: 1

(a) 1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-B
(b) 1-A, 2-C, 3-B, 4-D
(c) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D
(d) 1-C, 2-D, 3-A, 4-B

5. Statements: A. Democracy has eliminated conflicts among people. B. Democracy has eliminated economic inequalities. C. Democracy has eliminated political inequality as an idea. Which is the most defensible statement for the chapter? 1

(a) A and B are true
(b) Democracy has established the idea of political equality though it has not removed conflicts or economic inequality
(c) All three are true
(d) None of the democracies has political equality

6. Which is likely to be the long-term result of a majority forcing its will on others? 1

(a) More stable government **(b)** A federal system
(c) Weakened unity of the nation **(d)** Greater trust

7. Assertion (A): The Union Government can legislate on computer software. Reason (R): Computer software is not in any of the three lists. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

8. Which of the following can help reduce the gender gap in politics? 1

(a) Ending elections
(b) Banning women's organisations
(c) Reducing school enrolment
(d) Making fair representation of women legally binding

9. Assertion (A): Political parties are necessary for representative democracy. Reason (R): Without parties every candidate would be independent and no one would be responsible for how the country is run. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. A government takes decisions secretly, but quickly, and no citizen can check the process. Which of the democratic features is missing? 1

(a) energy **(b)** order **(c)** speed **(d)** transparency

11. Concentrating all political power in one person or group goes against which basic principle of democracy? 1

(a) parties should be banned
(b) the executive should be strong
(c) judges should be elected
(d) people are the source of all political power

12. Consider: (i) Residuary subjects are with the Union; (ii) Concurrent subjects are with the States alone; (iii) Union territories have no State-level powers. Which are correct? 1

(a) (i) and (iii) only **(b)** (ii) only
(c) (i) and (ii) only **(d)** (ii) and (iii) only

13. Which of the following is correct about the rural poverty ratio in 1999-2000 from the NSSO table? 1

(a) Hindu upper castes were highest **(b)** OBC was highest
(c) SC was higher than ST **(d)** ST (45.8) was higher than SC (35.9)

14. Assertion (A): Parties lack internal democracy. Reason (R): Parties do not keep membership registers or hold regular organisational elections. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

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15. A student concludes 'democracy is useless because it did not make her family rich'. A suitable reply from the chapter is: 1

(a) democracy only creates conditions and citizens must use them
(b) dictatorship is better
(c) she should leave democracy
(d) democracy always provides wealth

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Is the statement 'power sharing = dividing power = weakening the country' supported by the chapter? 2

17. Why do 'holding together' federations give unequal powers to units? 2

18. How is communal violence harmful for a democracy? 2

19. Why are recognised parties given symbols? 2

20. Why is the existence of social conflict not proof that democracy has failed? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Compare the importance of women's representation in Scandinavian countries and India. 3

22. Discuss how the rise of State parties changed Indian politics. 3

23. Discuss how democracy ensures that caste inequalities are challenged. 3

24. How might a federal arrangement have helped Sri Lanka? 3

OR

How do the three lists show the balance between unity and diversity? 3

25. Why is it dangerous when religion is seen as the basis of a nation? 3

OR

Examine how the media and movements can reform parties. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Critically evaluate the outcomes of democracy in terms of government quality, economy, inequality, social diversity and dignity. 5

OR

Show how a country can use reserved seats and local governments to share power. 5

27. Discuss the rise of regional parties and its effect on the Indian federal system. 5

OR

Compare the Indian secular state with the state in Sri Lanka, Pakistan and England. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks